

11th Grade: Building Your Foundation

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Junior year is lower-pressure, but it sets up everything. These are the moments to plan for together.

AUG
25

Meet with school counselor

Introduce yourself. Ask what 11th grade milestones to plan for.

SEP
15

Revisit college list

5-10 schools? Help think about reach, match, and safety categories.

OCT
1

Net price for every school on the list

Use net price calculators for each school. This changes everything.

OCT
15

PSAT/SAT — confirm participation

Many schools offer the SAT at no cost in October.

NOV
1

College rep visits season

Many colleges send reps to high schools in fall. Encourage attendance.

DEC
1

Scholarship deadline research

Many major scholarships open in fall and close December-January. Start a list.

JAN
15

Discuss what matters most

Ask: If you could only pick one thing in a college, what would it be?

MAR
1

Spring college fair season

Prioritize schools on your student's list.

APR
1

AP exams approaching

AP scores can earn college credit — saving real money. Encourage serious prep.

MAY
15

Start FAFSA prep

FAFSA opens October 1 of senior year. Gather: tax returns, FSA ID, asset info.

JUN
1

Request letters of recommendation NOW

Encourage your student to ask teachers before the school year ends.

JUN
15

Finalize college list over summer

6-10 schools (reach/match/safety) heading into senior year reduces stress.